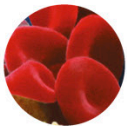


Blood and breathing

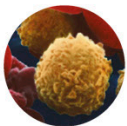
Every few seconds you breathe in air. Inside your lungs, oxygen from the air passes into your blood, which carries the oxygen all around your body.

Liquid of life

Blood is made up of three types of cells floating in plasma.



Red blood cells, the most common type of blood cell, carry oxygen.



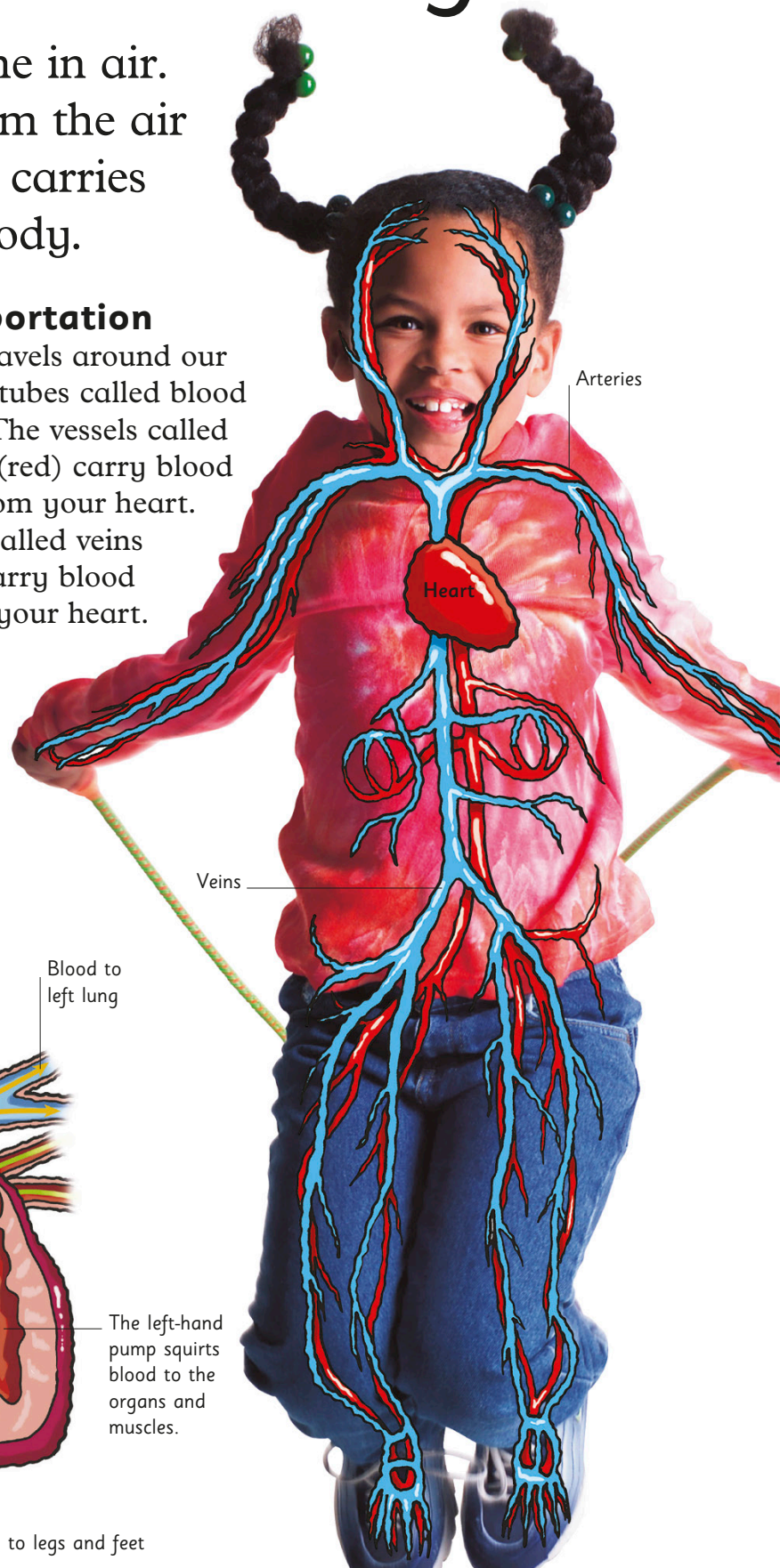
White blood cells, which are part of the immune system, fight disease.



Platelets help to repair broken skin and blood vessels.

Transportation

Blood travels around our body in tubes called blood vessels. The vessels called arteries (red) carry blood away from your heart. Vessels called veins (blue) carry blood back to your heart.



Your beating heart

Every time your heart beats, it pumps blood around your body. Half of the heart sends blood through your lungs. The other half sends blood around the rest of your body.

